Sales Performance Analysis, 2011-2014

Data: Superstore Sales (Kaggle) | Prepared by: Alexander Neumann | October 2026

Revenue grew 52% from 2011 to 2014 and profit grew even faster, but Furniture earns very little profit, the Central region is less profitable than its sales suggest.

Year	Revenue	Orders	Profit	Average order value
2011	$484,247.50	969	$49,543.97	$499.74
2012	$470,532.51	1,038	$61,618.60	$453.31
2013	$608,473.83	1,310	$81,726.93	$464.48
2014	$733,947.02	1,692	$93,507.51	$433.77
Grand Total	$2,297,200.86	5,009	$286,397.02	$458.61

Revenue growth: +52% from 2011 to 2014
Profit growth: +89% from 2011 to 2014

Key insights:

1. Revenue depends heavily on Q4
November and December together generate about 30% of annual revenue every year. This means supply or delivery problems in these months would hurt the business far more than problems at any other time of year.

2. Technology leads in profit, while Furniture earns less than 10% of total profit
Technology generates about 50% of total profit, while furniture has strong sales but a profit margin of only about 6%. Sales volume alone is a misleading measure of category performance.

3. Central earns less profit than its sales suggest, while South sells less
The Central region generates 22% of total revenue but only 14% of total profit, so its profit margin is lower than in other regions. The South region generates 17% of revenue and 16% of profit, so its margin is healthy, but its sales are low.

Risks or things to investigate:

Discounts appear to reduce profits, and the data does not tell us whether the extra sales justified this loss. This needs further analysis.

Recommendations:

1. Review the discount policy for Furniture, starting with heavily discounted orders.
2. Investigate why Central earns a lower share of profit than of revenue.
3. Look for ways to grow sales in the South, where profitability is healthy.

Method note:

Data prepared in Google Sheets, analyzed with pivot tables, and visualized in Power BI.